

Indian Forest Service Benevolent and Welfare Trust

STANDING FOR GREEN WARRIORS

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Wider Outreach, Policy Advocacy and Institutional Strengthening – September 2026 in Review

September was a month of wider institutional engagement and policy work for the Trust. During the month, the Trust addressed the 16th National Meet of State Biodiversity Boards (SBBs) and Union Territory Biodiversity Councils (UTBCs) at Chandigarh, held the Tenth Meeting of its Governing Body and the Second Meeting of State Coordinators and Nodal Officers, and filed its Income Tax Return and received report on the audit of the financial statements. The Trust continued to support ten cases across nine States, while the limited size of its corpus remained a major constraint in releasing the full assistance already sanctioned. For integrating the **SBI Collect** facility on the website of the Trust, most of the regulatory and technical formalities have been completed.

◆ NATIONAL OUTREACH



Briefing at the 16th National Meet of SBBs and UTBCs, Chandigarh, September 6–7, 2026

Trust at the 16th National Meet of State Biodiversity Boards and Union Territory Biodiversity Councils

The Trust addressed the Chairpersons, Member Secretaries and other officials attending the 16th National Meet of SBBs and UTBCs at Chandigarh on September 6–7, 2026.

The delegates were briefed on the history, revived mandate and activities of the Trust and on the assistance extended to forestry field personnel and their families.

Particular emphasis was placed on the role of frontline forestry personnel in protecting the country's forests, wildlife and biodiversity. The Boards and Councils were requested to create awareness about the Trust among forestry field personnel in their respective States and Union Territories and to facilitate timely reporting of deaths and grievous injuries occurring in the line of duty.

◆ TENTH MEETING OF THE GOVERNING BODY – SEPTEMBER 20, 2026

The Governing Body (GB) reviewed the Trust's assistance activities, financial position, statutory compliances, State outreach and fund mobilisation efforts. Among the important decisions and developments were:

- ▶ continued policy advocacy with State Governments for stronger institutional mechanisms for families of forestry personnel who make the supreme sacrifice or suffer grievous injuries;
- ▶ greater engagement with Principal Chief Conservators of Forests (PCCFs) and senior officers to strengthen awareness and participation among serving personnel;
- ▶ appointment of a new Chartered Accountant, with priority assigned to audit, filing of the Income Tax Return and pursuing income-tax exemption;
- ▶ preparation of a brochure and strengthening of the Trust's digital and social-media presence; and
- ▶ continued promotion of Sankalp 10K and other voluntary contribution mechanisms for building a sustainable corpus.

The GB also noted the registration of the Trust on the NGO-DARPAN portal and ratified the appointment of the State Coordinator and Nodal Officer for Madhya Pradesh.

◆ SECOND MEETING OF STATE COORDINATORS AND NODAL OFFICERS — SEPTEMBER 26, 2026

The Second Meeting of State Coordinators and Nodal Officers was held virtually on September 26, 2026. The deliberations focused on strengthening the Trust's outreach and building sustainable mechanisms for the welfare of forestry field personnel.

Among the new suggestions which emerged were:

- ▶ examining an institutional insurance or welfare mechanism for forestry personnel on the lines of arrangements available to the Armed Forces, Central Armed Police Forces, State Police and Railway Protection Force; the ongoing effort in Himachal Pradesh to explore a general insurance arrangement was also noted;
- ▶ widening State-level engagement to include associations and unions of frontline and subordinate forestry personnel, including daily-wage workers;
- ▶ using Zoos, National Parks, Wildlife Sanctuaries and other Protected Areas for public awareness, including display of standees carrying the Trust's website and contribution QR code during the tourist season;
- ▶ studying contribution models followed by other service and professional associations and examining practices that may be suitably adapted for the Trust;
- ▶ using the Eco Warrior Awards platform as an additional avenue for spreading awareness about the Trust; and
- ▶ holding a meeting of State Coordinators and Nodal Officers during the last week of every month to review progress, outreach and corpus mobilisation.

◆ POLICY ADVOCACY — LEARNING FROM THE STATES

During September, the Trust made a comparative study of compensation and welfare mechanisms available to forestry personnel in ten States and uploaded it on the website for the benefit of other States. The study covers dedicated forest-specific orders, general State employee schemes, salary-account insurance arrangements and employee-funded welfare mechanisms.

The exercise shows that different States offer different strengths. Maharashtra provides a comprehensive framework combining a uniform death benefit with family livelihood support and other incidental benefits. Telangana provides substantial disability and grievous-injury assistance and expressly recognises threats from extremist and anti-social elements. Karnataka provides substantial death assistance to frontline forest personnel. Overall, the Maharashtra model seems to be the best so far.

The study will support the Trust's continuing efforts to encourage States to put in place appropriate welfare and compensation mechanisms for forestry personnel. Letters have so far been addressed to the Hon'ble Chief Ministers of Gujarat and West Bengal.

◆ COMPLIANCE UPDATE

An important statutory milestone was achieved on September 28, 2026, when the Trust filed its Income Tax Return in Form ITR-5 for Assessment Year 2026–27. The return was electronically filed and verified and no balance tax remained payable after payment of the applicable tax and interest. The GB has also approved the balance sheet and received a report on the audit of the financial statements for the year 2025–26.

The Trust's application for income-tax exemption continues to be pursued.

◆ FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE — POSITION AT MONTH-END

No new beneficiary was added during September.

Since its revival, the Trust has extended assistance in ten cases across nine States. Assistance aggregating ₹22.85 lakh has been approved, of which ₹19.35 lakh has been released. Balance installments aggregating ₹3.50 lakh in three cases remain to be released as resources permit.

The position underlines the continuing need to build a stronger and more dependable corpus so that sanctioned assistance can be released without delay.

◆ CORPUS HIGHLIGHTS – SEPTEMBER 2026

480+ Total number of donors till date	₹24.85 lakh Total donations received so far after revival of the Trust
10 Number of families assisted	₹19.35 lakh Financial assistance released so far
27 Contributions received during September, 2026	₹1,50,602 Received during September, 2026

The forestry fraternity, serving and retired, remains the principal source of support to the Trust. Wider and more regular participation will be essential if the Trust is to respond promptly to every deserving case and gradually expand its welfare activities.

◆ ON THE HORIZON

- ▶ continue engagement with State Governments on dedicated welfare mechanisms for forestry personnel;
- ▶ continue engagements with PCCFs and other senior officers of the State Forest Departments for outreach of the activities of the Trust to all the forestry field personnel;
- ▶ pursue income-tax exemption;
- ▶ strengthen the monthly review system for State Coordinators and Nodal Officers;
- ▶ examine practical insurance and welfare models for frontline personnel;
- ▶ widen public awareness through forestry institutions, Protected Areas and other appropriate public platforms;
- ▶ intensify efforts to build a corpus capable of supporting every deserving case without delay; and
- ▶ integration of SBI Collect facility on the website of the Trust for receiving donations and automatic generation of receipts.

◆ SUPPORT THE CAUSE

Contribute to the Trust Corpus UPI ID: ifsbwt@sbi Account No.: 30454625682 Account Name: Indian Forest Service Benevolent and Welfare Trust Bank & Branch: State Bank of India, CGO Complex, Lodi Road, New Delhi – 110003 IFSC: SBIN0007837 PAN: AACTI5925J NGO-DARPAN ID: DL/2026/1100169 <i>Payments accepted via UPI · BHIM · Net Banking · Google Pay · PhonePe · Paytm</i> • Earmarked donations for specific cases are transferred in full to the named beneficiary family. The Trust acts as a facilitating agency and retains nothing.	
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Indian Forest Service Benevolent and Welfare Trust

Dedicated to the welfare of all forestry field personnel and their families

Frontline Field Staff · Forest Range Officers · State Forest Service Officers · Indian Forest Service Officers